

him to be a smith, and Hephaestus discovered that he was gifted with great skill in crafting metals.

*Hephaestus could shape anything from iron, silver, bronze, or gold. He became the god of smiths.*

Hephaestus decided to use his new skills to reclaim a place on Mount Olympus. He set about making a spectacular gold throne that was studded with precious stones. He gave it to his mother, Hera, as a gift. Hera admired the finely crafted chair and sat down on it immediately, but she had been tricked. The throne had a spell on it! Golden chains appeared and fastened around her arms and legs.

*Hera was trapped, unable to get up from her throne.*

Zeus was furious. "Release Hera immediately," he thundered at Hephaestus.

"Not until you show me the respect I deserve as a god," Hephaestus replied.

Zeus thought about this for a moment. "All right, Hephaestus," he said. "If you release your mother, then I will let you return to Mount Olympus and marry Aphrodite."

Aphrodite was the goddess of beauty, and Hephaestus agreed at once. From that day on, he lived on Mount Olympus with the gods.

*Hera was bound to the throne by golden chains.*

